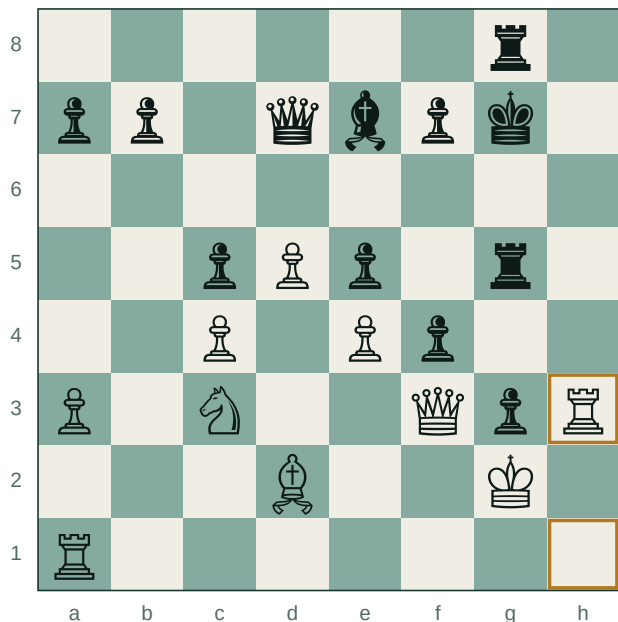


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 31

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 31.Rh3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...Qxh3+ 32. Kxh3 g2

31...Qxh3+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on h3. Recorded reply: **32.Kxh3**.

32...g2 The pawn moves from g3 to g2.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 20 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by -4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -4: the balance goes from +0 to -4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g2. Geometrically undefended: bishop on d2 and rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.